



THE GRYD

Product Brief for UI/UX Redesign

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Prepared for the UI/UX Design Team

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1. Product Overview

The Gryd is a **community platform built exclusively for credit unions**. It gives credit unions a private, branded space where their members, admins, and business partners (sponsors, vendors, investors) can connect, communicate, and collaborate within one app.

Think of it as a cross between Discord and WhatsApp, but purpose-built for financial institutions. It includes privacy controls, role-based access, content moderation, and multi-tenant architecture so each credit union gets its own branded community.

Core Value Proposition

PILLAR	DESCRIPTION
A Place for Members	Credit union members get their own community to connect, share, and engage with their CU and each other.
Add Business Partners	CU admins invite business partners (insurance, loans, sponsors) with verified badges so members know who they are talking to.
Partners Converse in Community	Partners are not siloed. They post in channels, DM members with offers, and join voice discussions alongside members.
Privacy First	Members are hidden by default. Non-friends see "Gryd Member" instead of the real name and photo. Members approve visibility through friend requests.

2. User Roles and Audience

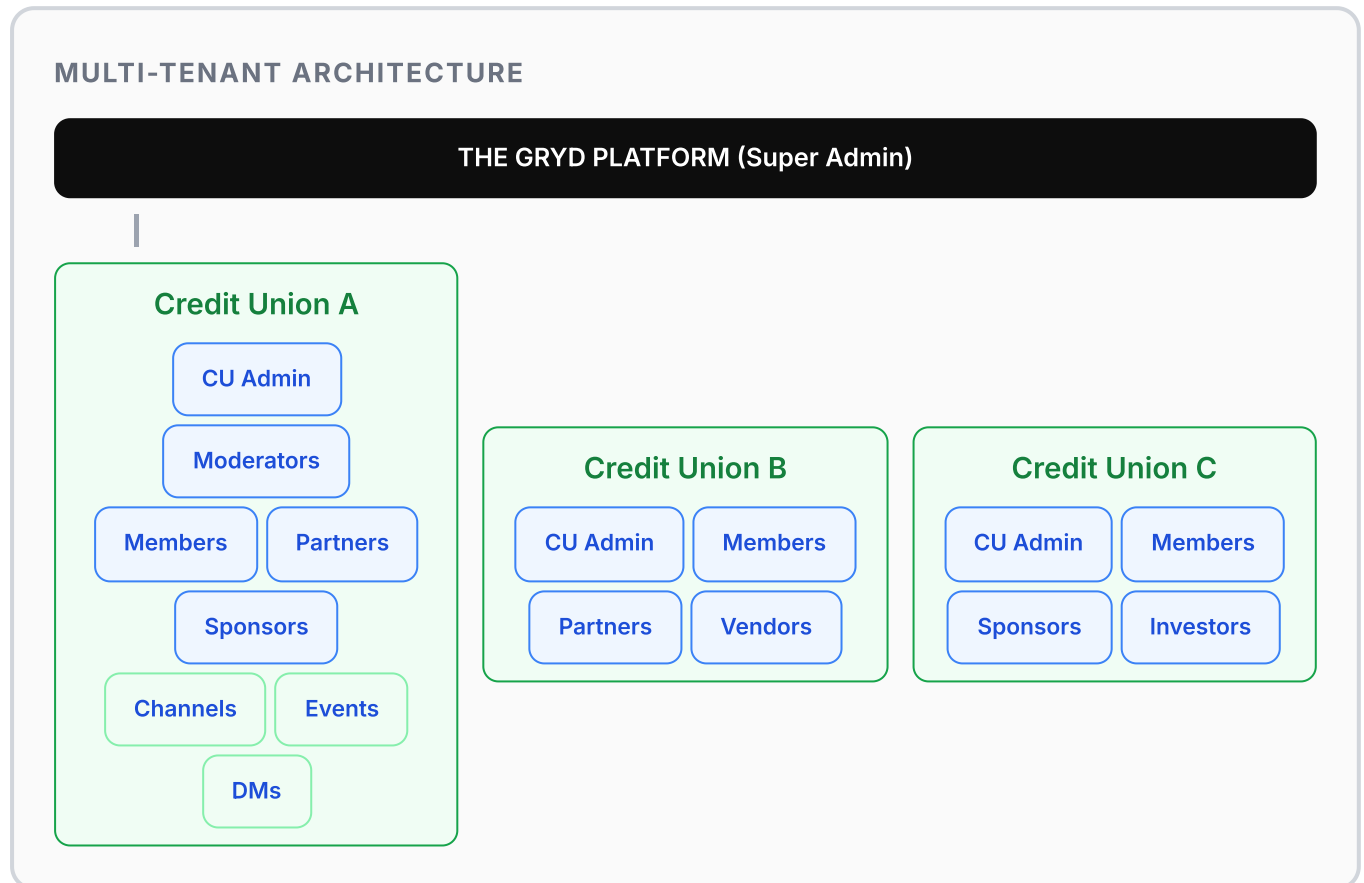
ROLE	BADGE COLOR	WHO THEY ARE	WHAT THEY DO
Member	#3B82F6 (Blue)	Credit union members (everyday users)	Browse feed, post, DM, join voice channels, make calls, manage privacy settings
CU Admin	#DC2626 (Red)	Credit union staff and managers	Manage members, channels, events, moderation, community settings
Moderator	#F97316 (Orange)	Appointed by CU Admin	Review flagged content, manage moderation queue
Partner	#10B981 (Teal)	External businesses (insurance, services)	Post in channels, DM members, join voice discussions with verified badge
Sponsor	#F59E0B (Amber)	Financial supporters of the CU	Same as Partner but with Sponsor badge
Vendor	#8B5CF6 (Purple)	Service providers	Same as Partner but with Vendor badge
Investor	#EC4899 (Pink)	Financial investors	Same as Partner but with Investor badge
Super Admin	N/A	Platform owner (internal)	Manages all credit unions (tenants), billing, platform config

Important for UI Design

Role badges must be instantly recognizable. They appear on every post, DM, voice channel participant, and profile. The badge color + label is the primary trust signal for members when interacting with partners.

3. Platform Architecture

The Gryd is **multi-tenant**. Each credit union gets their own "subgrid" (similar to a Discord server or Slack workspace). A single Super Admin manages all subgrids from a platform dashboard. Members join a specific credit union's subgrid via an invite link or code.



Each subgrid is fully isolated. Members of Credit Union A cannot see content from Credit Union B. Each CU admin has full control over their own community.

4. Complete Feature List

4.1 Core Communication

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	WHO USES IT
Community Feed	Post text, images, documents, voice messages. Like, comment, reshare. Role badges shown on every post.	All roles
Channels	Text channels (like #general), announcement channels, voice channels. Organized by categories.	All roles
Direct Messages	1-to-1 private messaging. Rich media support (images, files, voice messages, stickers). Online status indicators.	All roles
Voice Channels	Twitter Spaces-style live audio rooms. Roles: Host, Speaker, Listener. Wave-to-speak (raise hand) feature. Partners can speak alongside members.	All roles
Video and Voice Calls	HD calls powered by Agora. Incoming call screen with ringtone. Call history (incoming, outgoing, missed). Self-view frame during active calls.	All roles

4.2 Member Features

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION
Profile	Avatar, banner image, display name, bio, email, role badges. Fully editable.
Privacy and Safety	Profile visibility (Hidden / Friends Only / Public). DM controls (Everyone / Friends / Nobody). Friend request controls. Online status toggle. Members are hidden by default.
Friend System	Send, accept, decline friend requests. Block and unblock users. Mutual friends display.
Top Contributors	Points-based leaderboard. Podium view for top 3. Full ranked list below.
Notifications	Tabbed center: Messages, Mentions, Calls, System. Push notifications with priority channels (calls use MAX priority with ringtone).
Rewards / Affiliate	Referral link generation, click tracking, earnings dashboard, payout management.

4.3 CU Admin Features

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION
Overview Dashboard	Stats: total members, active today, channels, posts. Growth chart (7/30/90 day views).
Member Management	List with search. Assign roles (Member, Moderator, Partner, Sponsor, Vendor, Investor). Add, remove, ban, unban.
Channel Management	Create, edit, delete channels. Set type (text, voice, announcement). Manage permissions.
Event Management	Create events with title, date, time, location. Attendance tracking. Calendar view.
Moderation Queue	Review flagged content. Approve or reject. Prohibited word filter. Audit logs.
Invite System	Generate invite links and codes. Bulk invite via email.
Community Settings	Community name, description, notification preferences, moderation rules, custom roles.

4.4 Super Admin Features

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION
Platform Overview	Total customers (CUs), active channels, total members, active subscriptions. Growth charts.
Customer Management	View and manage all credit unions. Pause and reactivate. View plan details.
Platform Moderation	System-wide content moderation queue.
Billing	Subscription plans, payment processing.

5. User Stories

5.1 Member Stories

Member

As a **credit union member**, I want to **browse a community feed** so that I can stay updated on announcements, member discussions, and partner offers from my credit union.

Member

As a **member**, I want to **send a direct message to a business partner** so that I can ask about their exclusive CU member offers privately.

Member

As a **member**, I want to **join a live voice channel** where the CU admin and a partner are discussing new rates, so that I can listen and ask questions by raising my hand.

Member

As a **member**, I want my **profile to be hidden by default** so that non-friends (including partners) can only see "Gryd Member" until I accept their friend request.

Member

As a **member**, I want to **make a video call** to another member so that we can discuss credit union topics face-to-face.

Member

As a **member**, I want to **see a leaderboard of top contributors** so that I feel motivated to engage more in the community.

Member

As a **member**, I want to **control who can DM me** (everyone, friends only, nobody) so that I do not receive unwanted messages from strangers or partners.

5.2 Business Partner Stories

Partner

As a **business partner**, I want to **post in the community feed with my verified "Partner" badge** so that members can see my offers and know I am a trusted entity.

Partner

As a **partner**, I want to **DM members who have opted in** so that I can share exclusive insurance, loan, or service offers directly.

Partner

As a **sponsor**, I want to **join a voice channel discussion** alongside the CU admin and members so that I can present our products and answer questions live.

Partner

As a **partner**, I want to **see my badge on every message and post** so that members can immediately trust that I am a verified business entity, not a scammer.

5.3 CU Admin Stories

CU Admin

As a **CU admin**, I want to **invite business partners with verified badges** so that they can engage with my members in a trusted way.

CU Admin

As a **CU admin**, I want to **view community stats** (member count, active users, engagement) so that I can track the health of my community.

CU Admin

As a **CU admin**, I want to **moderate content and manage flagged posts** so that my community stays safe and professional.

CU Admin

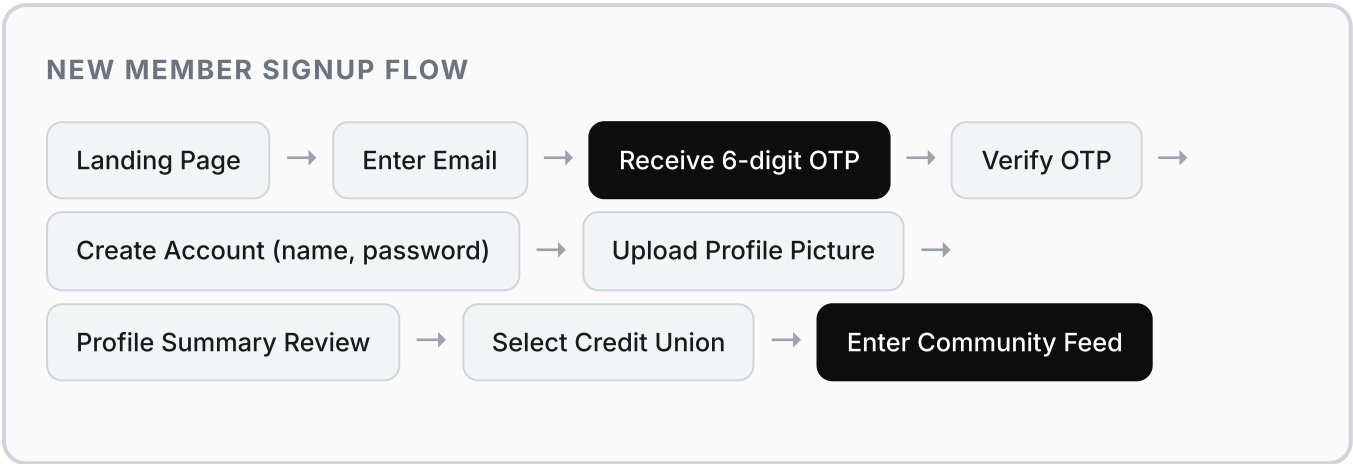
As a **CU admin**, I want to **create and manage events** (town halls, workshops) so that members and partners can participate.

CU Admin

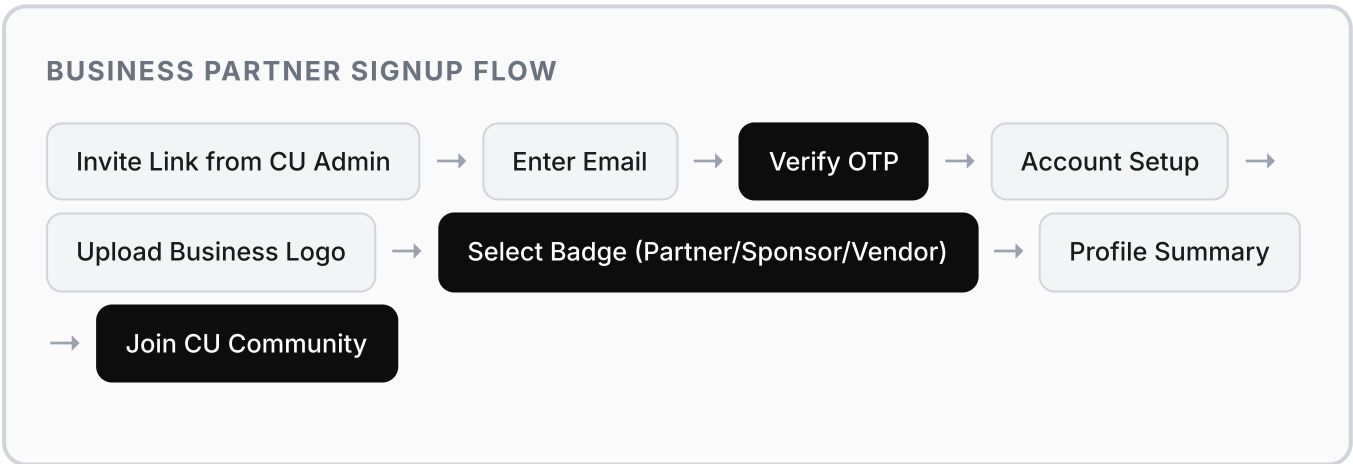
As a **CU admin**, I want to **host a voice channel** where I control who speaks, so that I can run structured community discussions with members and partners.

6. User Flows (Diagrams)

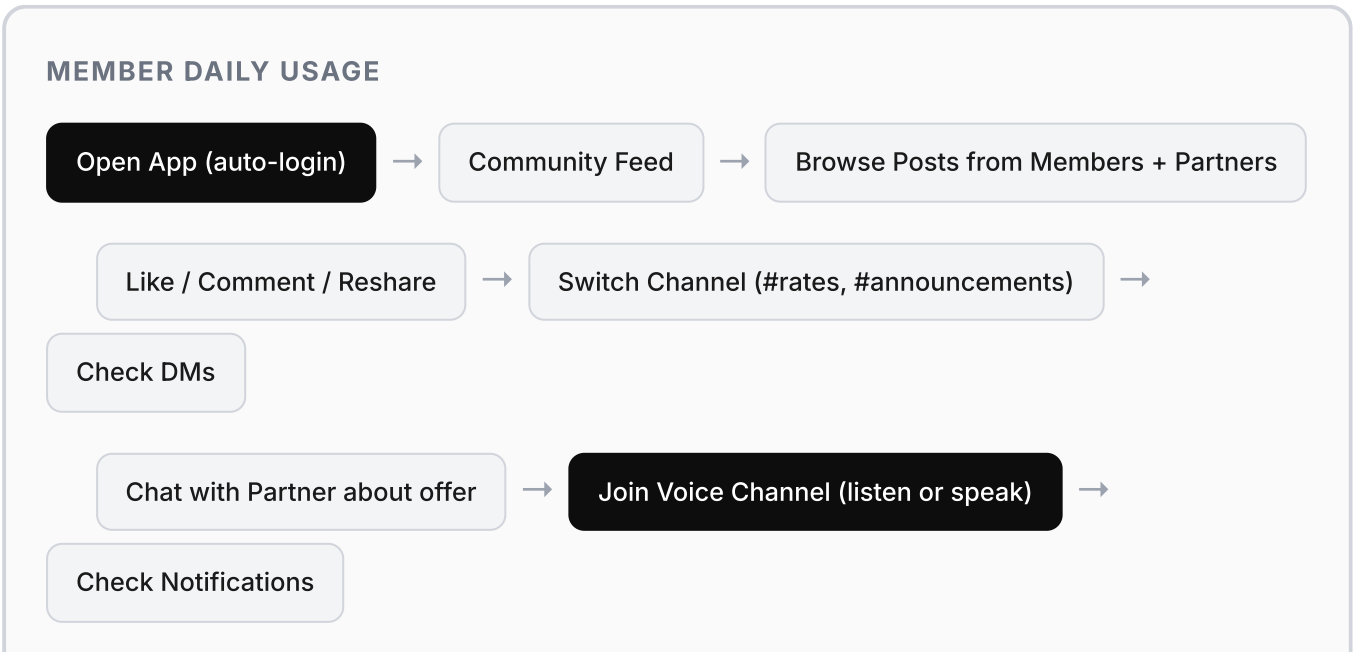
6.1 Member Onboarding



6.2 Partner Onboarding



6.3 Daily Member Flow



View Leaderboard



Manage Privacy Settings



Edit Profile

6.4 CU Admin Flow

CU ADMIN DAILY WORKFLOW

Login



Admin Dashboard (Overview)



Check Stats and Growth

Members Tab: Manage roles, add/remove



Invite Partner (assign badge)

Channels Tab: Create new channel



Review Moderation Queue

Create Event (Town Hall)



Post Announcement in Feed



Host Voice Channel

6.5 Partner Interaction Flow

HOW A BUSINESS PARTNER ENGAGES

Partner Joins via Invite



Verified Badge Assigned



Post in Community Feed

Members See Post with "Partner" Badge



Member DMs Partner



Partner Sends Exclusive Offer

CU Admin Hosts Voice Channel



Partner Joins as Speaker



Members Listen and Ask Questions

6.6 Privacy Flow

MEMBER PRIVACY AND VISIBILITY

Member Joins (Hidden by Default)



Non-friends see "Gryd Member"

Partner sends Friend Request



Member Accepts



Partner can now see real name/photo

Member can also set:



DM Controls



Friend Request Controls



Online Status Toggle

7. Screen Map

7.1 Authentication Screens

SCREEN	ROUTE	DESCRIPTION
Login	/login	Email input, then 6-digit OTP verification (passwordless)
Member Signup	/member-signup/*	5-step flow: email, OTP, account, photo, summary
Stakeholder Signup	/stakeholder-signup/*	Similar flow with badge type selection
Super Admin Signup	/super-admin-signup	Secret key + account creation form
Admin Setup	/setup	CU admin initial setup + invite members
Join via Invite	/join/[token]	Accept invite and join community

7.2 Main App Screens (Member and Partner)

SCREEN	ROUTE	DESCRIPTION
Community Feed	/(main)/	Posts with channels tabs, reactions, composer. Default landing screen.
Direct Messages List	/(main)/direct-messages/	Conversation list with online status, unread badges, partner labels.
Chat	/(main)/direct-messages/[peerId]	1-to-1 messaging with media, voice messages, call buttons.
Voice Channel	/(main)/voice-channel	Spaces-style audio room with speaker/listener sections.
Sub Channel	/(main)/sub-channel	Channel-specific content view.
Profile	/(main)/profile	User profile with avatar, banner, bio, badges, edit options.
Top Contributors	/(main)/top-contributors	Leaderboard with podium and ranked list.
Notifications	/(main)/notifications	Tabbed: Messages, Mentions, Calls, System.

Rewards	<code>/((main))/rewards</code>	Affiliate dashboard: referral stats, earnings, payouts.
Privacy Settings	<code>/((main))/privacy-settings</code>	Visibility, DM, friend request, and online status controls.

7.3 Admin Screens

SCREEN	ROUTE	DESCRIPTION
CU Admin Dashboard	<code>/admin</code>	Tabs: Overview, Members, Channels, Settings
Admin Messages	<code>/admin/messages</code>	Admin DM management view
Super Admin Dashboard	<code>/super-admin</code>	Platform-wide management (customers, billing, moderation)

7.4 Modals and Overlays

COMPONENT	DESCRIPTION
CallModal	Full-screen call UI with self-view, remote video, and controls (mute, video, end)
IncomingCallOverlay	Incoming call notification with caller info, accept and decline buttons
Voice Message Player	Inline audio player in chat with waveform and duration

8. Current Design System

8.1 Color Palette (Dark Theme, Primary)

TOKEN	HEX	USAGE
appBg	#0D0D0D	App background
surface	#1A1A1A	Cards, input backgrounds
surfaceMuted	#242424	Secondary surfaces, hover states
text	#FFFFFF	Primary text
textMuted	#A1A1A1	Secondary text
textSubtle	#6B6B6B	Timestamps, hints
border	#2E2E2E	Borders, dividers
primary	#3B82F6	Primary actions, sent messages
error	#EF4444	Errors, delete actions
sidebar	#141414	Navigation sidebar

8.2 Color Palette (Light Theme)

TOKEN	HEX	USAGE
appBg	#F5F5F5	App background
surface	#FFFFFF	Cards
text	#111827	Primary text
textMuted	#6B7280	Secondary text
border	#E5E7EB	Borders
primary	#111827	Primary actions

8.3 Typography

PROPERTY	VALUE
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Font Family	Inter (via @expo-google-fonts/inter)
Weights	Regular (400), Medium (500), SemiBold (600), Bold (700)
Headers	28-32px, Bold
Titles	18-20px, Bold
Body	14-16px, Regular
Labels	12px, SemiBold
Small Text	10-11px, Regular

8.4 Spacing and Sizing

ELEMENT	VALUE
Default Padding	16px
Compact Padding	12px
Minimal Padding	8px
Button Border Radius	8-12px
Card Border Radius	12-16px
Avatar (Large / Profile)	100px
Avatar (Standard / List)	40-48px
Avatar (Small / Comments)	32-36px
Button Heights	36-48px
Message Bubble Max Width	70-80% of screen

8.5 Icon Library

Library: lucide-react-native (v0.562+)

CATEGORY	ICONS USED
Navigation	MessageCircle, Trophy, User, ChevronDown, Search, Menu
Communication	Phone, Video, Mic, Bell, Flag, Send
Media	Image, File, Paperclip, Volume2

Interaction	Heart, Repeat2 (reshare), MessageCircle (comment), Award
Status	Check, CheckCheck, X, AlertCircle, Shield, Lock
Voice	Crown (host), Hand (raise hand), Headphones

8.6 Logo

The logo is a stylized hash mark (#) with curved, tapered lines on a black rounded-square background. The lines are white. The hash is slightly rotated for a dynamic feel.

Asset files: icon.png, adaptive-icon.png, splash-icon.png

9. Tech Stack

Provided for context so the designer understands platform capabilities and constraints.

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	NOTES
Mobile App	React Native + Expo (SDK 54)	Single codebase for iOS and Android
Web App	Expo Web (same codebase)	Responsive web version
Routing	Expo Router (file-based)	URL-based navigation
State Management	React Query + AsyncStorage	Server state caching and offline persistence
Real-time	Socket.IO (WebSocket)	Instant messaging, typing indicators, presence
Voice/Video Calls	Agora RTC SDK	HD audio/video, up to 100 participants
Backend	Node.js + Express	REST API
Database	MongoDB	NoSQL document store
Auth	JWT + OTP (passwordless)	No passwords. Email-based OTP only.
Push Notifications	Expo Notifications	Custom Android channels for calls/messages
File Storage	Cloudinary	Images, documents, voice messages
Backend Hosting	Render	Auto-deploy from git
Web Frontend Hosting	Vercel	Auto-deploy from git

10. Key Design Considerations

#	CONSIDERATION	DETAILS
1	Mobile-first	Most users will be on mobile (iOS/Android). Desktop/web is secondary. Design for mobile first, then adapt to larger screens.
2	Dark mode is primary	The app currently defaults to dark mode. Light mode exists but is secondary. Design dark mode first.
3	Role badges are critical	Users must instantly recognize whether someone is a Member, Partner, Sponsor, Admin, etc. Badges appear everywhere: posts, DMs, voice channels, profiles. The badge color + label is the primary trust signal.
4	Privacy is a core differentiator	"Hidden by default" is a key selling point. The UI should clearly communicate privacy status and make settings easily accessible. The anonymized "Gryd Member" profile should feel safe, not broken.
5	Partners are first-class citizens	Partners are not just observers. They post, DM, join voice channels, and appear in the feed. The UI should make member-to-partner interaction feel natural and trustworthy.
6	Credit union branding	Each CU subgrid should feel like "their" community, not a generic platform. Consider how CU logos, names, and colors can be surfaced.
7	Multi-platform consistency	The app runs on iOS, Android, and Web. Design should work across all three with consistent patterns.
8	Accessibility	Consider contrast ratios for dark mode, touch targets for mobile (minimum 44pt), and screen reader compatibility.
9	Performance perception	Use skeleton loaders, optimistic updates, and smooth transitions to make the app feel fast even on slower connections.
10	Onboarding clarity	The OTP-based login (no passwords) may confuse first-time users. The signup flow has 5 steps. Each step should feel lightweight and progress should be clear.

11. Client's Core Narrative

The client's vision for The Gryd centers on three core ideas that should drive every design decision:



A Place for Members

Credit union members get their own community to connect, share knowledge, and engage with their CU.



Add Business Partners

CU admins invite partners with verified badges so members know exactly who they are engaging with.



Partners Converse

Partners are not siloed. They post in channels, DM members, and join voice rooms alongside everyone.

Design Principle

Every screen should reinforce these three ideas. The community feed shows members AND partners posting together. The DM list shows partner conversations with badges. The voice channel shows admins, members, and partners in one room. The design should make this multi-role interaction feel seamless, trusted, and natural.